

Summer Worship

We are taking advantage of our side lawn and once again having one worship service at 10:00, outside, for the summer.

- On June 5, we are celebrating our graduates, and we are recognizing Jenia Strom's last Sunday with us on staff. There is a potluck lunch and a time for tributes after the service.
- June 12 will include the blessing of bikes and bike helmets, and we will welcome Rev. Jean Elliott as our new Director of Ministries with Children, Youth, and their Families.
- Becky will be gone on renewal leave June 20-July 31. In her absence, members of our congregation have graciously agreed to preach and lead worship. We are lucky to have so many people willing to share their stories with us in worship!
 - ⇒ June 26 – Trevor Hicks is preaching
 - ⇒ July 3 – Les Linster is preaching about why he is involved in our food ministries
 - ⇒ July 10 – Jason Emrick is preaching
 - ⇒ July 17 – Eric Strom is preaching on change and resilience
 - ⇒ July 24 – Kip Kirkpatrick, Maureen Trepp, and Gene Thompson are preaching about why their faith has led them to be involved in Racial Justice
 - ⇒ July 31 – Lisa Talcott is preaching on the importance of welcoming
- August 7 is our annual Worship at the Falls. Join us at the bandshell in Minnehaha Falls Park at 10:30 for an ecumenical worship service. You can also go to Bethel Evangelical Lutheran Church (4120 17th Ave. S) where the livestream of the service will be shown.
- August 28 is our annual pet blessing; bring your pet, or a stuffed animal, or a picture of your pet to be blessed.



Baptism of Rylan H.



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About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multi-cultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

United Women in Faith

Here's some summer UWF (formerly known as UMW) news:



United
Women
in Faith

- We continued to serve for a wedding reception and funeral in May: Lani Thompson's wedding on May 14 and Alice Streed's funeral on May 18. Thank you to all the volunteers who have helped with this. Please let Kim Kanuit know you are available to help in the future; many of our funerals have been on weekends and we need prep for them the night before, also. Kim's email is kanuitkk@q.com and cell is 612-860-0256.
- Simpson Neighborhood services continues to need meals and we have supplied them during the spring: Thanks to servers John Darlington, Paula Barton, Kevin Korell, Kitty Campbell, Jenny Ammerman, Sarah Emrich, Char and Craig Johnson and Kevin's niece Alicia for their help and applause to Margaret Rawson for some great meals!! We served again on May 31 and are looking forward to June 27 and July 26. Easy to do: meet at church to carpool at 5:30 or go to Simpson Shelter on 28th St. and 1st Ave. So.. Prep and serve dinner to about 50 homeless folks, finishing about 8:00. We can always use your help. Contact Maureen Trepp at maureentrepp@yahoo.com or cell 612-387-2520
- Several WUFers attended virtually the 2022 General Assembly over May 20-21 at church along with 12 women going to the Annual Emma Norton Dinner/Fundraiser in April. Emma Norton Services is the only UMC mission in Minnesota and is expanding as they build new homes for women and children in the Highland Bridge project.
- Hold onto that Rummage thru the summer! Save the Dates! Big Rummage Sale on Sept. 15-17: we need you and your stuff! Bring items (no large furniture or clothes) the two Sundays before, Sept. 4 and Sept. 11 in the morning and leave in the Fellowship Hall. Sign up for when you can help: Sorting and pricing Sept 13-14, Sale 9/15, 9-6, 9/16, 9-6 and Bag Sale only 9/17 9-noon, clean-up after. Let anyone on the Leadership Team know you want to help!!

Thank you for being you, stay well and take care of your children, parents, neighbors, strangers, nature and.....God Bless!

Leadership Team: Maureen Trepp, Kim, Kanuit, Margaret Rawson, Kitty Campbell, Jenny Ammerman, and Char Johnson



New Covid-19 Metrics

We have been using a set of metrics around Covid-19 statistics to guide our activities for about a year now. The metrics were based on CDC guidelines and statistics gathered by the state of Minnesota. Both the state and the CDC have now changed their guidelines and the way they gather statistics. So, here are our new metrics:

You may remember that we set metrics in the fall about how Covid-19 numbers would affect how we gather. Recent changes in numbers have dropped us below some of our markers, so here is where we are currently:

Community level of **Green** + 8 weeks following vaccines available for children age 6 mo. – 4 years:

Masks are optional.

All programming happens as scheduled.

Communion is served with individual pieces of bread and individual cups.

Community level of **Yellow** (or green and vaccines not yet available for the youngest children):

Masks are required indoors.

All programming happens as scheduled, but we hold events outside as much as we can.

Communion is served with individual pieces of bread and individual cups.

Community level of **Red**:

Masks are required inside.

Any programming involving food is cancelled or postponed.

Communion is served pre-packaged.

If there are other changes in CDC or MN State guidelines, the Covid Task Force will meet to determine new metrics. Thank you all for your thoughtfulness and patience as we continue to walk this journey!



Chilly start to our outdoor worship season!



Summer 2022 at Minnehaha UMC

**Compassion Camp: Changing the World With LovingKindness
An Evening Intergenerational Vacation Bible School**

When: Monday, June 20-Thursdays, June 23 from 6-7:30pm

Where: Minnehaha Side Lawn

Who: Children with their Families, and People of All ages welcome & encouraged



**Squirrels & Others:
Making a Musical, Saving the Animals
Minnehaha Music & Drama Camp**



When: Monday, August 1-Friday, August 5th from 9-3pm
Evening Performance on Friday, August 5th

Where: Minnehaha Side Lawn

Who: Kids who have completed kindergarten through eighth grade

**Minnehaha Youth to
KoWaKan BWCA Base Camp Experience**

When: Tuesday, July 12-Saturday, July 16

Where: KoWakan, Ely, MN

Who: Youth who have completed 5th-12th Grade



CHILDREN & FAMILIES

Wednesday, June 1 at 6:30pm: Family Fun Night - Summer Kick-Off. Both Jenia & Jean will be there, we'll play, eat ice cream, work in the garden and more

Future Family Fun Night Dates will be announced soon!



MIDDLE & HIGH SCHOOL YOUTH

Sunday, June 12th at 4pm: Youth Summer Kick-Off for Youth. Parents are welcome as well as we'll welcome Jean Elliott to the Youth Program

Tuesday, June 14th - and Tuesdays throughout the Summer - Minnehaha Youth Nights

Questions?

Contact education@minnehaha.org



Introducing Jean Elliott

Hello! I'm Jean Elliott, the new Director of Children, Youth, and Families at Minnehaha UMC. I am honored and excited to serve in this role and to be a part of this community. My desire for these ministries is to continue to be places where children and youth feel welcomed, affirmed, and supported as they deepen relationships with each other and their church family, and also reflect God's love in service and community. I'm passionate about creating and supporting faith formation opportunities for children and youth with teams of dedicated volunteers and mentors.

My own faith formation began in my hometown church, White Bear Lake UMC, with supportive adults from Sunday school, VBS, service-learning trips, retreats, and youth group. Since then my journey of listening to God's nudges has brought me to a call to lifelong ministry which has been in a variety of settings including camping, campus, and congregations.



Second grade Bible presentation



Worship and Lunch at the Falls

Will be on Sunday, August 7. Join with our ecumenical friends at Bethel Evangelical Lutheran Church, Bread of Life Deaf Lutheran Church, and Lake Nokomis Lutheran Church for a joint worship service at the Minnehaha Falls Park bandshell at 10:30. If you want to continue in conversation after worship, bring a bag lunch and we'll have lunch together at the tables behind the bandshell. If you can't make it to the park, but still want to worship with others, the service will be livestreamed at Bethel Evangelical Lutheran Church (4120 17th Ave. S).

Animal Blessing

Animals play an important role in many of our lives. If you have a special pet, we invite you to bring it to our annual animal blessing service on Sunday, August 28. We'll gather inside if it is raining, but either way, there will be a time in the worship service to have your pet blessed. Whether you have a horse or a hamster, bring them to church. Just make sure it's in a crate or container or on leash of some kind. If you don't have a pet, but wish you did, come anyway, and bring a stuffed animal if you'd like. If your pet doesn't like crowds, other animals, or can't really get out, bring a picture and we'll bless that. You may also wish to recognize the death of a pet in this way. And, invite your friends to bring their pets as well; we welcome everyone.





Welcoming New Staff

As Jenia leaves as our Program Director of Children, Youth, and Families, it is normal to feel some sadness and grief, and maybe a little anxiety or uncertainty about the new person. As Rev. Jean Elliott steps into that role, here are some suggestions for welcoming her and making that transition:

- Open your hearts and minds to a new person who will have a different personality and do things in a different way.
- Introduce yourself; repeatedly! Remember that Jean has not been part of this community before. Wear nametags – all the time! Which is a good reminder in general, by the way. We always have someone in our midst who has not been here before.
- Don't assume Jean knows something. Give her background, explain relationships, and make sure she is aware of meetings, gatherings, etc.
- Give support and encouragement! Let her know what you appreciated about something she did, and what she did well.
- And, let her know when you want or need something. If you want more of something or less of something, let her know that as well. But before you do that, make an internal assessment. Is this a need of the program or of children and youth? Keep in mind that Jean's personality should shine through what she does, and it might shine a little bit differently than Jenia's did.
- Try not to start a sentence with "Jenia always . . ." Again, do an internal assessment. If you can rephrase your feedback with a connection to your values or the values of the congregation, then Jean will have a better sense of what you are trying to communicate.
- Know that this is a journey. Jean is learning about us, and we are learning about her. Refer to the first point regularly – keep an open heart and an open mind as we welcome a new staff person with new perspectives, gifts, and skills.

Newcomer Class

We'll be holding an introduction and orientation class for anyone new to Minnehaha or interested in joining on Sunday afternoon, August 21 at 11:00 a.m. You can come in person or attend via zoom; when you RSVP (becky@minnehaha.org), just let us know which way you'd like to attend.

Racial Justice Committee Report

Team Lead, Kip Kirkpatrick

Your Racial Justice committee has been meeting regularly through this loooong winter/spring and have come up with some ideas that might contribute to our church community's need for racial justice action.

Eleven of us viewed the "Human Toll: A Public History of 35W" exhibit at the Hennepin History Museum and encourage you to see it also as it tells the story of the devastation of residential neighborhoods in south Minneapolis with the construction of 35W. The "Separate but Not Equal: The Hale Field Pairing" exhibit was not up when we went but is there now and shows this historic act that changed the Minneapolis Public Schools more than 50 years ago.

Land Acknowledgement: We are working on writing a Land Acknowledgement Statement, drawing on many resources, including our participation in the Conference *Lenten Study: A Transformational Journey Towards a Land Acknowledgement Statement*.



Reading Recommendations:

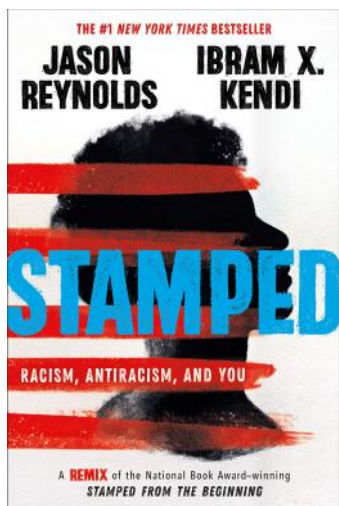


- *Waking Up White by Molly Irving As a white, female author, Molly Irving examines her awareness of White Privilege. The most striking aspect of this study book is what actions she took and how she learned from those. This would be a great study guide with questions at the end of each chapter as we come to realize how far we need to go to understand our differences. It is aimed at white people who haven't a clue about White Privilege. Recommended by Bev Pederson (notes from an interview with Bev).

- The Children's Library at MUMC is on the second floor and several books have been added following the protests of 2020 and related to Racial Justice; they are marked with blue on the binding.

- *Stamped - A Remix This remarkable reimagining of Dr. Ibram X.

Kendi's National Book Award-winning *Stamped from the Beginning* reveals the history of racist ideas in America, and inspires hope for an antiracist future. It takes you on a race journey from then to now, shows you why we feel how we feel, and why the poison of racism lingers. It also proves that while racist ideas have always been easy to fabricate and distribute, they can also be discredited. This nonfiction book is meant for middle grades and older. (This is the adaptation of *Stamped* for the Beginning, with a youth audience in mind. Ibram X. Kendi collaborated with Jason Reynold.)



The Racial Justice Committee has also written a statement of intent and is interested in letting our community know about events that address racial justice issues such as performances, marches and speakers. Please join us as we form a community of persons interested in learning how to be and act anti-racist. Questions? Please send an email to Kip at kip.m.kirkpatrick@gmail.com.

PRIDE!

As you may know, Minnehaha is part of Minnesota Reconciling Congregations (MRC) which, since 1984, encompasses over 34,000 Reconciling United Methodists who publicly witness to “open the doors” of the church to the participation of all people regardless of sexual orientation or gender identity.

After no PRIDE in 2020 and limited celebration in 2021, it is time to celebrate the 50th anniversary of PRIDE in 2022! MRC would like MINNEHAHA’S HELP to make this a great PRIDE celebration!

There are two easy ways to volunteer with MRC at PRIDE this year!

Booth in Loring Park! Help let PRIDE attendees know that there is a place for them in Methodist congregations! Jobs are available for both introverts and extroverts. Sign up for your shift online at: ttsu.me/4zejnb

Help set-up on Friday, June 24 from 9 - 11 a.m.

Work a two hour shift on Saturday, June 25 or Sunday, June 26. During the shift, you greet visitors and hand out rainbow peace medallions. If you're not so sure about interacting with visitors, you can help remove peace medallions from their wrappers.

Take-down/clean-up on Sunday, June 26 beginning at 6 p.m.

March along Hennepin Avenue! The March (formerly known as the Parade) begins at 11 a.m. on Sunday, June 26 and will go from 7th & Hennepin to Loring Park. This is a great way to be part of the PRIDE celebration! All ages are welcome to participate. We won't have a vehicle or float this year - we are looking for PEOPLE! Everyone is encouraged to wear any rainbow or colorful clothes you can! Don Prestly is coordinating The March preparations. Please contact him at don.prestly@gmail.com with questions.

More information will be sent out to all volunteers closer to PRIDE!

MinneHarvest

Our free food give-away once a month is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. We gather outside on the 4th Saturday of each month. You can volunteer anytime between 6:30 and 10:30 a.m. We start setting up at 6:30, unload the truck starting at 7, serve the food starting around 7:30, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30. Join us for all or any portion of that time, dress appropriately for the weather, and bring a friend! We'll be offering food on June 25, July 23, and August 27.



Senior High Youth hang new Pride flag

“Will Party”

Saturday, June 11 at 10:00 am

On Saturday, June 11, at 10:00 am on the side yard (inside if it rains), Minnehaha UMC will host another “Will Party” event. All are invited to attend, young and old.

The “Will Party” will provide an opportunity for those who wish to start or revise a Will to meet with an attorney. Steve Otto of Otto Law (www.ottoesq.com), a Twin Cities law firm focusing on estate planning/probate administration and business law, will be at the meeting to talk about Wills, answer your questions, and to meet one-on-one to discuss your estate planning needs. (There is no charge for this initial consultation.) If you would like to have a Will drawn up or do other estate planning, you can set up a follow-up meeting.

Childcare will also be provided upon request. RSVP’s not necessary but appreciated so we know about how many will be attending. Questions regarding this event and RSVP’s may be directed to Kim Kanuit at 612-860-0256 (Call or Text).





Renewal



I will be on Renewal Leave this summer from June 20 – July 31. The United Methodist Church has had in its rules an encouragement for clergy to take some downtime periodically for decades. It is only recently that clergy have realized how important it is to take this seriously. The Discipline (the United Methodist rulebook) says that clergy can take a month of renewal leave (time off with no specific purpose other than recharging one's soul) every four years. These days, that renewal leave is required for clergy who serve as district superintendents, with one DS on leave for 1-3 months every year. And, the availability of the Lily Grant has meant that clergy for all denominations have taken seriously what a 3-month period of time off might look like. The Lily Grant is given to clergy who pass an application process, and it pays for travel, pulpit supply, and some resource money for leaders to lead events in the congregation that are tied to the theme of the clergyperson's leave. People have gotten Lily Grants for things like learning to make an outdoor bread oven, to photography as a spiritual practice, to "wilding," the importance of being outside.

"Part of the fun of each renewal leave has been the time that precedes it ..."

To be clear, I am not doing a Lily Grant leave, just a regular, ordinary renewal leave. In 30 years of ministry, this will be my 5th renewal leave. If you do the math, you can see that I did not make my original goal of going every 4 years, but each renewal leave has been important, and I believe has sustained my soul for the work of ministry.

Part of the fun of each renewal leave has been the time that precedes it – time where I contemplate where I might want to travel and what I might want to see. This year, Martha and I will be packing up our travel trailer and the dogs and heading out to Nova Scotia. We originally wanted to see the huge tides on the Bay of Fundy, and then we discovered lots of other things we want to see as well. In my absence, some of the clergy who attend Minnehaha will be on call for funerals (Heather in the office will have a list of who is on call each week), and members of the congregation will be sharing their own faith journeys and stories in their sermons. I am very much looking forward to this time to recharge my soul so that I am reinvigorated for the next 4 years of ministry!

In Joy,
Becky





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6/22

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